🔑 **Answer Key — Teacher Copy · Lesson 2-11**

MSTAR PRACTICE WORKSHEET

Lesson 2-11: Add and Subtract Decimals

Grade 6 Mathematics · Standard 6.NOS.3

These are MSTAR-style questions written for this curriculum to rehearse the format. They are not official Maryland assessment items. MSTAR — Maryland's new state test, first given in spring 2027 — uses the same kinds of questions you see here: selected response, select-all, two-part evidence questions, and written responses.

Part A — Skills Check

One point each.

Question 1 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: C

What is 14.6 + 3.85?

(A) 17.45

(B) 18.35

(C) 18.45

(D) 18.55

Line up decimals: 14.60 + 3.85. Hundredths: 0 + 5 = 5. Tenths: 6 + 8 = 14, write 4 carry 1. Ones: 4 + 3 + 1 = 8. Tens: 1. Answer: 18.45.

Question 2 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: B

What is 20.3 – 7.48?

(A) 12.18

(B) 12.82

(C) 12.92

(D) 13.82

Rewrite as 20.30 – 7.48. Annex a zero so both have two decimal places. Work carefully with borrowing: 20.30 – 7.48 = 12.82.

Question 3 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: C

What is 9.05 + 4.7?

A 13.12

B 13.57

C 13.75

D 14.75

Line up decimals: 9.05 + 4.70. Hundredths: 5 + 0 = 5. Tenths: 0 + 7 = 7. Ones: 9 + 4 = 13. Answer: 13.75.

Question 4 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: A

What is 50 − 23.47?

A 26.53

B 26.63

C 27.47

D 27.53

Rewrite 50 as 50.00. Then 50.00 − 23.47 = 26.53. You must borrow across multiple places.

Question 5 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: C

A student buys items costing $4.59, $12.75, and $3.80. What is the total cost?

A $20.14

B $21.04

C $21.14

D $21.24

4.59 + 12.75 + 3.80 = 21.14. Line up decimal points and add column by column.

Question 6 SELECTED RESPONSE — CORRECT: C

Case File: A crew member's snack receipt shows $27.60 for dried fruit and $15.45 for protein bars. What is the total on the receipt?

A $42.05

B $42.95

C $43.05

D $43.15

Line up the decimal points: 27.60 + 15.45. Hundredths: 0 + 5 = 5. Tenths: 6 + 4 = 10, write 0 carry 1. Ones: 7 + 5 + 1 = 13, write 3 carry 1. Tens: 2 + 1 + 1 = 4. Total: $43.05.

Part B — Test-Format Questions

Scoring notes and distractor rationales below each item.

Question 7 TWO-PART QUESTION

Part A — correct answer: C

Find 12.4 + 3.75.

(A) 4.99

(B) 15.15

(C) 16.15

(D) 16.79

> Line up the decimal points and use a placeholder zero: 12.40 + 3.75 = 16.15.

- **A:** That is 124 + 375 with the decimal points ignored. Line the points up first, then add.
- **B:** The carry was dropped: 0.40 + 0.75 = 1.15, so a whole 1 carries into the ones place.
- **D:** Write 12.40 so every column has a digit, then add the hundredths first: 0 + 5 = 5.

Part B — correct answer: C

Why is a placeholder zero written as 12.40 rather than leaving 12.4?

(A) It changes the value of 12.4 to make the addition work.

(B) Zeros must always be written at the end of a decimal.

(C) It makes both numbers have the same number of decimal places so each column holds the same place value.

(D) It rounds the answer to the nearest hundredth.

> 12.4 and 12.40 are equal in value. The zero simply fills the hundredths column so digits with the same place value line up in the same column.

Question 8 WRITTEN RESPONSE · 2 POINTS

Type II Reasoning: Lining Up the Wrong Edge

> Malik computed 9.6 + 0.45 by lining up the RIGHT-hand edges of the digits, as if adding whole numbers. He got 1.41.

Explain Malik's misconception and give the correct sum.

> **Model answer:** 9.60 + 0.45 = 10.05. Decimals are lined up by the decimal point, not by the right edge, so that each column holds one place value. Estimation confirms it: 9.6 is nearly 10, so the sum must be just over 10.

2 points	Student explains that decimals are aligned by DECIMAL POINT so that tenths add to tenths and hundredths to hundredths, and computes 9.60 + 0.45 = 10.05.
1 point	Student gives 10.05 without explaining place-value alignment.
0 points	Student agrees with Malik or gives an unrelated response.

Part C — Show Your Thinking

Model answer and scoring guidance.

Question 9 WRITTEN RESPONSE · 2 POINTS

A runner's lap times are 2.45 minutes, 2.6 minutes, and 2.38 minutes. Her personal record is 7.5 minutes total. Did she beat her record? Show all your work with decimal alignment and explain.

Model answer: Padded to hundredths, the three laps total 2.45 + 2.60 + 2.38 = 7.43 minutes. Compared place by place with 7.50, the tenths digit 4 is less than 5, so 7.43 < 7.50 and she did beat her record — by 0.07 minute. The comparison only works because both numbers are written with the same number of decimal places.

Award 2 points for a complete explanation with correct mathematics, 1 point for a correct answer with thin reasoning, 0 for an unrelated response.

Answer Key. Score written responses with the rubric and guidance above; award partial credit per the 1-point rows.